

discussed in Chapters 5 and 14 imply a reflation into the 2020s or 2030s, which could approach or become a runaway trend before reversing, a scenario that is compatible with this cycle. The next low is due in 2118, which is only seven years past the projected ideal Kondratieff cycle low discussed in Appendix B, supporting the outlook for a very deflationary environment that ends in the second decade of that century, reasonably timed to occur a couple of decades after the final stock market bottom is due, as outlined in Chapter 5.

This outlook is limited to the *overall* trend of commodity prices. From time to time, certain individual commodities might go against the trend under conditions specifically relating to them. Most prices fall during a deflation, but particular items can rise in price because of *shortages* due to such conditions as drought, mine closings, crop failure or destruction (intentional or otherwise), and bankruptcies of commodity production businesses, or *special demand* for certain materials due to particular events, such as war. Suffice it to say that these will be markets for speculators, not for most investors.